Sprint 5 Reflection

Euphrata Teshome

In this sprint, I was responsible for building and improving the library, updating the UI, and helping connect the frontend with Firestore. One of my contributions was designing the library section so that users could learn six words per day, view definitions, examples, and synonyms, and track their daily progress. I worked on the UI design to make it clean, simple and easy to use. I also made updates to the app structure, set up the tab navigation for library and Activities, and I fixed various errors in typescript types and components. Another part I contributed to was connecting the library with Firestore so the words could load from our database instead of using only local files. I also helped clean up the project structure by removing old folders, fixing type errors, and preparing the code so it could be pushed safely to the master branch.

Throughout this sprint, I faced several challenges. The biggest challenge was dealing with Git issues—especially merge conflicts, untracked files, and problems with node_modules. A lot of these problems came up because our project had multiple folders and older versions of the app still inside the repository. Some files were not supposed to be tracked by Git, but they were still inside the project, which caused Git to get confused every time I tried to pull or push. On top of that, node_modules takes up thousands of files, and since it wasn't ignored at first, it kept causing conflicts and slowed down the process. At one point, my local project and the remote repository were not aligned, which caused errors when pushing. I had to learn how to use git add, git rm -r --cached, .gitignore, pull with rebase, and clean my working tree. I also struggled with Firestore limits and errors in the backend communication. These issues took a lot of time, but I solved them by researching, getting help, and working through each problem step by step.

This sprint taught me so much. I learned how to properly manage a React + TypeScript project, organize files, and structure components. I also learned new Git skills that I didn't know before, especially how to fix complicated repo states. I feel much more confident using Firebase, Firestore, and Vite now. On top of that, I learned how valuable consistency and debugging skills are in real teamwork.

For improvement, I want to work on time management and communicating earlier when I am stuck. I also want to become faster at debugging errors and more comfortable with Git so things go smoother next sprint. Overall, I grew a lot this sprint, and I'm proud of the work I contributed.